

HR Attrition Insight Summary

Prepared by	Data Set	Date
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1. Problem Statement

For this project, I looked at employee attrition data from IBM's HR Analytics dataset. The dataset has 1,470 employee records and 35 columns covering things like age, salary, department, job satisfaction, overtime, and whether the employee left the company or not.

The business problem I was trying to answer was: why are employees leaving, and which groups of employees are most at risk of leaving?

Understanding this is important because every time an employee leaves, the company has to spend money and time finding and training a replacement. If HR knows which segments are at risk, they can take action before people decide to quit.

2. Key Findings

After cleaning the data and exploring it in Excel, I found the following patterns:

- **Overall attrition rate**

Out of 1,470 employees, 237 left the company. That is an attrition rate of about 16%, which is higher than the typical 10–12% seen in most industries.

- **Sales has the highest attrition**

The Sales department had an attrition rate of around 21%, which was the highest across all departments. Research & Development was lower at about 19%. This was a noticeable difference and suggested something specific to the Sales environment might be causing people to leave.

- **Young and new employees leave the most**

Attrition was highest among employees aged 18–25 and those who had been with the company for less than 2 years. This suggests that the company may be struggling to retain people early in their career or early in their time at the company.

- **Overtime is strongly linked to attrition**

Employees who worked overtime were significantly more likely to have left compared to those who did not. This was one of the clearest patterns in the data.

- **Low salary is linked to higher attrition**

Employees in the lowest salary band had a noticeably higher attrition rate than those earning more. This pattern appeared consistently across departments, not just in Sales.

3. Root Cause Hypotheses

Based on these findings, I came up with a few possible reasons behind the patterns. These are hypotheses — they would need to be confirmed through stakeholder interviews or more detailed research.

Possible Cause	My Thinking
Burnout from overtime	Employees working long hours may feel overworked and undervalued. Without proper support, this can push people to look for other jobs.
Pay below market rate	Employees in lower salary bands may be receiving offers elsewhere with better compensation. If the company is not competitive on pay, especially for junior roles, people will leave.
Poor early experience	The high attrition in the first 2 years may mean that new employees are not getting enough support, clarity, or growth opportunities early on. A weak onboarding experience can make people feel disconnected from the company.
Sales target pressure	The Sales department likely has high-pressure targets with income tied to performance. This kind of environment can cause stress and early burnout, especially for newer employees.

4. Recommendations

- **Address overtime**

The business should consider reviewing workload distribution, particularly in the Sales department and for employees who are regularly working overtime. A simple check-in process where managers flag consistently overworked employees could help catch burnout early.

- **Review compensation for junior roles**

The business should consider doing a salary benchmarking exercise for roles in the lower income bands. If pay is significantly below market, it will continue to be a reason for people to leave. Even small adjustments can make a difference in retention.

- **Improve support for new joiners**

The business should consider strengthening the onboarding process for employees in their first year. Things like a buddy system, a clear 90-day plan, and regular check-ins could help new employees feel more settled and less likely to leave early.